- Achieve wanted pregnancy and child birth
- Spacing the pregnancies
- Determine the number of children in the family
- Choose the age for becoming pregnant

Contraception

Measures designed to prevent pregnancy due to coital act either temporary or permanenty

Temporary Methods Of Contraception

I. Natural Method

Rhythm Method:

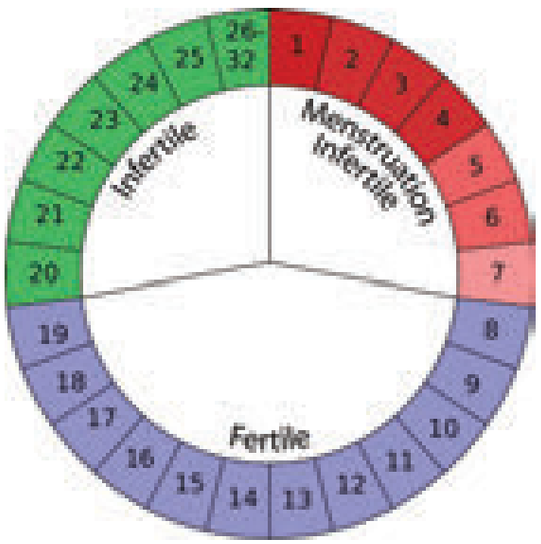
The menstrual cycle is divided into three phases for purpose of assessment of likelihood of conception.

Phase-1: relatively infertile phase last from onset of menstruation until the time of preovulation.

Phase-2: fertile phase. last from seven days preovulation to 48hrs post ovulation.

Phase-3: absolutely infertile phase lasts from 48hrs after ovulation until the onset of menstrual, bleeding about 10 – 16 days.

Methods to determine the phase of the cycle:



Testing cervical mucus:

During phase 1 and 3, the mucus is scanty , thick and breaks quickly when stretches. During phase 2, the mucus is more abundant thick and clear and stretches easily.

Measuring basal body temperature:

Basal body temperature should be measured in the morning. A sustained rise of temperature of 0.2 to 0.6 C indicates that ovulation has occurred

Advantages	Disadvantage
• No physical side effects • Economical • No method-related health risks	• High failure rate • No protection against sexually transmitted diseases (STD's) Hepatitis - B, HIV

Abstinence Complete abstinence

Coitus interruptus - During sex the man withdraws his penis from the vagina before he ejaculates

Lactational Amenorrhoea Method

It suppresses ovulation and thickens cervical secretions. It is effective in women less than 6 weeks of postpartum, who are breastfeeding.

Emergrncy Contraception

It reduces sperm transport and changes the endometrium thus unfavorable for fertilization. It is effective for women who have had unprotected intercourse within 72 hours and for victims of sexual assault.

Advantages of natural methods

- Natural method that does not require devices or medicine in the body.
- There are no side effects.
- No cost. Is morally and culturally acceptable.
- Better than not using any birth control method

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